



NRSP Safety Tip of The Week
By: Dovid Rosenberg



24 Hr Hotline
845-442-2900

Here are some bicycle safety tips for riding in your neighborhood:

1. **Wear a helmet:** It's crucial for protecting your head in case of a fall or collision.

2. **Follow traffic rules:** Obey stop signs, traffic lights, and lane markings.

3. **Be visible:** Wear bright or reflective clothing, especially at dawn, dusk, or night.

4. **Use hand signals:** Indicate turns and stops to alert drivers and pedestrians.

5. **Stay alert:** Watch for potholes, debris, and parked cars, and be mindful of pedestrians and pets.

6. **Ride defensively:** Anticipate the actions of drivers and pedestrians and be prepared to react.

By following these tips, you can reduce your risk of injury and enjoy a safe ride in your neighborhood!

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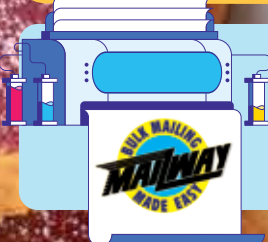
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The Community Corner is a not-for-profit program aimed to bring younger members of our community into shul with excitement. We would love to hear any feedback or comments. Any comments should be emailed to Submissions@Ourcommunitycorner.com



Community Service Announcement! Lets all have a safe Shabbos and wear a reflector when going outside!

COMMUNITY CORNER

SUCCOS EDITION

PARSHAS HA'AZINU האזינו

ISSUE # 200

BS"D

OCTOBER 3, 2025

FRIDAY, 11 TISHREI, 5785



SHABBOS STARTS: 6:16 PM (18 MINUTES)

SHABBOS ENDS: 7:22 PM (50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM: 7:46 PM (72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

Made possible by contributing writers of Ohr Yaakov Shlomo- 43 Tamarack Lane, Pomona, NY.

STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz



Rabbi Pinchas of Koretz was a spiritual giant in his generation. At first, his greatness was mostly unknown to his contemporaries, but he had no regrets; indeed, it suited him just fine. He spent his days and nights in Torah-study, prayer and meditation. Rarely was he interrupted.

But then, the word began to spread, perhaps from fellow disciples of Rabbi Israel Baal Shem Tov, that Rabbi Pinchas was very, very special. People began to visit him on a regular basis, seeking his guidance, requesting his support, asking for his prayers and beseeching his blessing. The more he helped them, the more they came. The trickle to his door became a stream and the stream became a daily flood of personal stories and requests for help.

Rabbi Pinchas was overwhelmed. He felt he was no longer serving G-d properly, because he no longer had sufficient time to study, pray and meditate as he should. He didn't know what to do. He needed more privacy and less distraction, but how could he turn away dozens and even hundreds of people who genuinely felt that he could help them? How could he convince them to go elsewhere, to others more willing and qualified than he?

Then he had an idea. He would pray for heavenly help in the matter. Let G-d arrange it that people not be attracted to seek him out! Let G-d make him be despicable in the eyes of his fellows!

"A tzaddik decrees and Heaven agrees," they say. Rabbi Pinchas prayed and so it became. No longer did people visit him. Not only that, on those occasions when he went to town, he was met with averted heads and a chilly atmosphere.

Rabbi Pinchas didn't mind at all. Indeed, he was delighted. The old pattern was restored; rarely was he interrupted.

Then the "Days of Awe" of Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur passed, and there remained only four brief busy days to prepare for the Sukkot festival. In previous years, there had always been some yeshiva students or local townspeople who were only too glad to help the pious rabbi construct his sukkah-hut. But this time, not a single soul arrived. No one liked him, and no one even thought to help him.

Not being handy in these matters, the rabbi didn't know what to do. Finally, having no choice, he was forced to hire a non-Jew to build his sukkah for him. But the hired man did not possess the tools that were needed, and Rabbi Pinchas could not get a single Jew in the neighborhood to lend him tools because they disliked him so much. In the end, his wife had to go to borrow them, and even that was difficult to accomplish due to the prevailing attitude towards her husband. With just a few hours remaining till the onset of the festival, they finally managed to complete a flimsy minimal structure.

As the sun slid between the forest branches and the Rebbetzin lit the festive candles, Rabbi Pinchas hurried off to shul. Despite his solitary ways, he always made a point to attend the congregational prayers on the holidays; besides he didn't want to miss the opportunity to acquire a guest for the festival meal, something so integral to the essence of the holiday.

In those days in Europe, people desiring an invitation to a meal would stand in the back of the shul upon the completion of the prayers. The householders would then invite them upon their way out, happy to so easily accomplish the mitzvah of hospitality. Rabbi Pinchas, unfortunately, did not find it so simple. Even those without a place to eat and desperate for an invitation to a sukkah in which to enjoy the festival meal, turned him down without a second thought. Eventually, everyone who needed a place and everyone who wanted a guest were satisfied, except for the tzaddik, Rabbi Pinchas.

He trudged home alone, saddened and a bit shaken up at the realization that he might never have another guest, not even for the special festive meal of the First Night of Sukkos. Alas, that too was part of the price of his freedom.... It was worth it, wasn't it?

Pausing just inside the entrance to his sukkah, Rabbi Pinchas began to chant the traditional invitation to the Ushpizin, the seven heavenly guests who visit every Jewish sukkah. Although not many are privileged to actually see these exalted visitors, Rabbi Pinchas was definitely one of the select few who had this experience on an annual basis. This year, he raised his eyes and saw the Patriarch Abraham—the first of the Ushpizin and therefore the honored guest for the first night of the festival—standing outside the door of the sukkah, keeping his distance.

PARSHA QUESTION By: The Rabbi

How is Haazinu laid out in the Torah?

Answer to last weeks parsha question:

Q. Which body of water was Moshe told he would not cross?

A. The Yarden.

MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadesh



Succos. Here are a couple of things to think about for Succos:

Did Bnei Yisroel do the mitzvah of lulav and esrog and sit in a sukkah in the desert? Some say they did not sit in a sukkah because the whole reason for sitting in the sukkah is to remember the "clouds of glory" that surrounded them in the desert, and if they were actually surrounded by the clouds in the desert they would not have to remember the clouds. Another reason they may not have made a sukkah in the desert is because it would end up being under the "clouds of glory" and would be like a "sukkah under a sukkah" which is not allowed.

Regarding the lulav and esrog, they may not have done it because the pasuk says they should do that mitzvah "when they gather in the crops of the holy land" which they were not in yet. Additionally, the Rambam in his "more nevuchim" explains the reason for the mitzvah of lulav and esrog is to celebrate leaving the desert and going into Eretz Yisroel where the lulav, esrog etc. grow and are easily accessible. Some say that Bnei Yisroel may have actually taken a lulav and esrog because they may have grown miraculously in the desert or they may have gotten the from Ein Geddi where the midrash says they got wine for the libations for sacrifices. (Various sources)

Rabbi Pinchas cried out to him in anguish: "Father Abraham! Why do you not enter my sukkah? What is my sin?"

Replied the patriarch: "I am the embodiment of Chesed, serving G-d through deeds of loving-kindness. Hospitality was my specialty. I will not join a table where there are no guests."

The crestfallen Rabbi Pinchas quickly re-ordered his priorities. He prayed that everything be restored to as it had been, and that he should find favor in the eyes of his fellows exactly as before. Again his prayer was answered. Within a short time, throngs of people were again finding their way to his door; seeking his guidance, asking his support, requesting his prayers, and beseeching his blessing. No longer could he devote all or even most of his time to his Torah-study, his prayer, and to his meditation. But thanks to his holy Sukkot guest, this was no longer seen as a problem.



